

对话 1

Receptionist: Hi there! Welcome to FitZone Gym. How can I help you today?

Student: Hi! I'd like to sign up for a gym membership—just for one month to start.

Receptionist: Sure! We have two monthly plans. The basic plan is \$35, and the full-access plan is \$50.

Student: What's the difference?

Receptionist: Basic includes the gym equipment only. Full-access includes gym equipment, yoga, spinning, **plus access to the swimming pool.**

Student: Hmm... I don't swim, but I might join a yoga class. Are there any student discounts?

Receptionist: Yes, students get \$5 off either plan with a valid student ID.

Student: So the basic plan is \$30, and **the full one is \$45?**

Receptionist: Exactly.

Student: When does the membership start? Immediately?

Receptionist: It can start today or on the first day of next month—you choose.

Student: I'll start today. What time does the gym open in the mornings?

Receptionist: On weekdays, we open at 6 a.m., **but on weekends it's 7 a.m.** We close at 10 p.m. every day.

Student: Great. Do I need to pay any extra fees?

Receptionist: **Only a one-time registration fee of \$10, but that's waived if you choose the full-access plan.**

Student: Oh, that's good to know. I think I'll go with the full-access one then.

Receptionist: Would you like to pay by cash or card?

Student: Card, please. And do I get a membership card today?

Receptionist: **Yes, it'll take about 10 minutes to print.**

Student: Perfect. Thank you so much.

Receptionist: You're welcome! Enjoy your workouts!

Question 1. What extra benefit is included in the full-access plan?

- A) Free locker rental
- B) The swimming pool**
- C) Personal trainer sessions
- D) Free gym clothing

Question 2. How much does the full-access monthly plan cost for students?

- A) \$30 B) \$35 C) \$40 **D) \$45**

Question 3. What time does the gym open on weekends?

- A) 5 a.m. B) 6 a.m. **C) 7 a.m.** D) 8 a.m.

Question 4. What do we learn from the conversation about the registration fee?

- A. It is a one-time payment added to new memberships.**

B. It costs \$10 but is not required for the full-access plan.

C. It must be renewed together with monthly fees.

D. It is refunded if the customer cancels within a week.

Question 5. How long will it take to get the membership card?

A) About 5 minutes

B) About 10 minutes

C) About 30 minutes

D) About 60 minutes

答案 : B, D, C, B, B

对话 2 :

Host: Welcome back to Campus Voices! Today, we have Sarah, a second-year biology student, to talk about her volunteering at the City Animal Shelter. Hi, Sarah!

Sarah: Hi! Thanks for having me.

Host: So, what made you decide to volunteer there? Was it because you love animals?

Sarah: Well, partly, yes. I've always liked animals. **But honestly, at first, it was mainly to get community service hours for a scholarship application.**

Host: Oh, really? So it wasn't just passion?

Sarah: Not at the beginning. But after a few weeks, it became much more than that. I started to notice how scared some of the rescued dogs and cats were, and I wanted to help them feel safe again.

Host: That sounds meaningful. What kind of work do you do there?

Sarah: I help clean the cages, feed the animals, and sometimes assist the staff during check-ups. On weekends, I join adoption events, where people come to meet the animals.

Host: Was it difficult at first?

Sarah: Yes, especially emotionally. Some animals arrive injured or abused. I thought cleaning would be the hardest part, **but actually, it was seeing animals that had lost trust in humans.**

Host: How did you deal with that?

Sarah: **One of the senior volunteers told me to be patient and quiet around them.** Over time, some dogs started wagging their tails when I came. That felt really special.

Host: Did volunteering change your perspective in any way?

Sarah: Definitely. **I used to think volunteering was just about helping others, but I realized it also changes you.** I became more patient and responsible. And I'm even considering studying animal behavior in the future.

Host: Wow! That's quite a change from volunteering just for hours.

Sarah: Yeah, I didn't expect that.

Host: What's the biggest challenge now for you as a student?

Sarah: Time. **Balancing assignments, exams, and weekend shifts is tough.** I sometimes wake up at 6 a.m. to finish homework before going to the shelter.

Host: That's dedication. Finally, what would you say to students who want to volunteer?

Sarah: Don't do it only for certificates. That motivation won't last long. Go with an open heart, and you might discover something important—about animals and about yourself.

Host: Beautifully said. Thank you, Sarah.

Sarah: Thanks for having me!

Question 6. What was the woman's initial reason for volunteering at the animal shelter?

- A) She wanted to study animal behavior.
- B) Her father is a famous biologist.
- C) She has always loved animals.
- D) She needed it for a scholarship.**

Question 7. What does the woman say was the most difficult part at the beginning?

- A) Waking up early in the morning
- B) Cleaning up animal cages
- C) Seeing abused and fearful animals**
- D) Organizing adoption events

Question 8. What helped the woman gain the animals' trust?

- A) Giving them special food
- B) Speaking loudly to show confidence
- C) Being patient and quiet around them**
- D) Taking them for long walks

Question 9. How did volunteering change the woman?

- A) She realized volunteering is simply about helping others.
- B) She learned it can change the person who volunteers.**
- C) She believes it is an important part of off-campus life.
- D) She decided to study animal behavior for her thesis.

Question 10. What challenge does the woman mention near the end of the conversation?

- A) Financial problems caused by volunteering
- B) Lack of support from the school administration
- C) Difficulty in communicating with other volunteers
- D) Managing time between schoolwork and volunteering**

答案：

1. D
 2. C
 3. C
 4. B
 5. D
-

News Report 1

Two buses and two other vehicles crashed early Wednesday on a highway in western Uganda, **killing 46 people**, police said, in one of the worst motor accidents in the East African country in recent years. Several others were injured in the crash that happened after midnight local time on the highway to Gulu, a major city in northern Uganda.

Two bus drivers going in opposite directions attempted to overtake other vehicles and collided near the town of Kiryandongo, according to police. “In the process, both buses met head-on during the overtaking maneuvers,” the police statement said.

In Uganda, **5,144 people were killed in road crashes in 2024**. That number rose from 4,806 in 2023 and 4,534 in 2022, according to official police figures, which show a rise in the total number of those killed or injured in road crashes in recent years.

“As investigations continue, we strongly urge all motorists to exercise maximum caution on the roads, especially avoiding **dangerous and careless overtaking, which remains one of the leading causes of crashes in the country**,” the police said in their statement after the latest crash.

Question 11

How many people were killed in the latest crash in western Uganda?

- A. 36
 - B. 40
 - C. 46**
 - D. 56
-

Question 12

How many people were killed in road crashes in Uganda in 2024?

- A. 4,534
 - B. 4,806
 - C. 5,144**
 - D. 5,600
-

Question 13

According to the police, what remains one of the leading causes of crashes in the country?

- A. Speeding at night
- B. Careless overtaking**
- C. Driving without a seatbelt
- D. Poor weather conditions

答案：C,C,B

News Report 2:

Character.AI, an app that allows users to create customizable characters or interact with those generated by others is banning minors from using its chatbots **amid growing concerns about the effects of artificial intelligence conversations on children.** The company is facing several lawsuits over child safety, including by the mother of a teenager who says the company's chatbots pushed her teenage son to kill himself.

Character Technologies, the California-based company behind Character.AI, said Wednesday it will be removing the ability of users under 18 to participate in open-ended chats with AI characters. The changes will go into effect by Nov. 25 and **a two-hour daily limit will start immediately.** Character.AI added that it is working on new features for kids — such as the ability to create videos, stories, and streams with AI characters.

Character.AI said it will be rolling out age-verification functions to help determine which users are under 18. A growing number of tech platforms are turning to age checks to keep children from accessing tools that are not safe for them.

Critics welcomed the move but said it is not enough — and should have been done earlier. Meetali Jain, executive director of the Tech Justice Law Project, said, “There are still a lot of details left open.”

“They have not addressed how they will operationalize age verification, how they will ensure their methods are privacy preserving, nor have they addressed the possible psychological impact of suddenly disabling access to young users, given the emotional dependencies that have been created,” Jain said. **“Moreover, these changes do not address the underlying design features that facilitate these emotional dependencies – not just for children, but also for people over the age of 18 years old.”**

Question 14

Why is Character.AI banning minors from using its chatbots?

- A) Due to complaints about the app's poor performance

B) Due to concerns and lawsuits related to children

C) To launch a new, separate app just for children

D) To comply with new government regulations

Question 15

Which change will be implemented immediately for users under 18?

A) Deletion of all their account data

B) A new child-safe warning message

C) A two-hour daily limit on app use

D) A new process to verify user age

Question 16

According to the critic Meetal Jain, who can develop emotional dependence due to the platform's design?

A. Only teenagers using AI frequently

B. Only users with psychological problems

C. Both minors and adults over 18

D. Mainly parents monitoring their children

答案：B, C, C

News Report 3:

This week, Swiss Federal Railways (or SBB) announced plans for a new night train called EuroNight. It will go from Basel in Switzerland to Copenhagen in Denmark and Malmö in Sweden.

A company spokesperson said the new service makes eco-friendly trips to Northern Europe easier for people. It also helps meet the rising need for green travel across borders.

The EuroNight will run three times a week in both directions. The first trip is set to start on April 15, 2026. The train will cover about 1,400 kilometers and carry around 350 passengers. Tickets for the service will go on sale from November 4, 2025.

Night trains are quickly becoming a favorite way to travel in Europe. But high costs are slowing down their growth.

Recently, Austria's rail company ÖBB said it will stop its night trains from Paris to Vienna and Berlin starting in mid-December, following the French government's withdrawal of funding.

The plan for this new sleeper train from Switzerland to Sweden is not final yet. The rail company is waiting for government money to be approved.

The Swiss government has set aside €50.6 million until 2030 to help international night trains. This is part of the CO2 Act, which aims to cut the country's emissions in half over the next five years. But parliament still needs to approve it in the winter session.

If the money is not approved, SBB says it will inform customers and **refund any tickets that have already been booked.**

Question 17

What route will the new EuroNight train take?

- A) From Paris to Vienna and Berlin
 - B) From Basel to Copenhagen and Malmö**
 - C) From Zurich to Munich and Hamburg
 - D) From Geneva to Oslo and Stockholm
-

Question 18

When is the first EuroNight trip scheduled to begin?

- A) November 4, 2025
 - B) December 2025
 - C) April 15, 2026**
 - D) Mid-December 2026
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Question 19

Why will some night train services be stopped by Austria's rail company ÖBB?

- A) Because passenger numbers have dropped sharply.
 - B) Because some trains have become too old.
 - C) Because new safety rules increased the costs.
 - D) Because the French government withdrew funding.**
-

Question 20

What will SBB do if the government funding is not approved?

- A) Raise ticket prices
- B) Reduce weekly trips
- C) Delay the train service
- D) Refund booked tickets**

答案：B, C, D, D

Although the term “best friend” only became widely used in the 20th century, the idea has existed since ancient times. The famous philosopher Aristotle described three kinds of friendship: those based on pleasure, on usefulness, and on virtue. Friendships of virtue were considered the highest form. These relationships are not just enjoyable or practical — they are stronger and last longer because each person tries to help the other become a better person.

Best friendships were especially important for women in the past, says Jaimie Arona Krems, an associate professor of psychology and director of the UCLA Center for Friendship Research. Historically, when women married, they often left their own homes and communities to live with their husbands’ families. Without their own relatives nearby, friends — especially best friends — became essential sources of support. Today, many young adults move away from their hometowns for school or work, so friends often take on roles similar to family.

In studies, people describe friends with words like trustworthy, honest, supportive, loyal, reliable, kind, pleasant, available, positive, open, understanding, and fun. Best friends share all of these qualities, but more deeply. Krems explains: “There’s more trust, more openness, more understanding, more emotional closeness, a stronger feeling of shared reality.” You can also have more than one best friend, depending on the situation — such as a best friend from childhood, from work, or from the gym.

Whether a spouse should be considered a best friend is often debated. In Krems’s research, many people do not list their romantic partner or family member as their best friend, even though they say they want their partner to be one.

Calling someone a “best friend” also means admitting that other friends are less close. This may sound cold, but researchers say people naturally rank their relationships. One theory, suggested by British evolutionary psychologist Robin Dunbar, says humans can only maintain about 150 social connections — known as Dunbar’s number. These people are placed into different layers, from the closest friends in the inner circle to people you might only recognize on the street. Because our time and emotional energy are limited, we can’t stay close to everyone we know. So, we are more likely to invest in the friends we have already spent a lot of time with — usually the three to five people in our closest circle.

This ranking system can sometimes become uncomfortable or obvious in public. For example, at weddings, one person is chosen as the best man or maid of honor. This can surprise others because people often hide their friendship rankings, Krems explains, to “make several people believe they are our best friend.”

Question 21. According to the philosopher Aristotle, what is the highest form of friendship?

- A) A bond built mainly for pleasure
 - B) A useful connection for daily needs
 - C) A social link based on shared interests
 - D) A bond where both help each other grow**
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Question 22. Why were close friendships especially important for women in the past?

- A) They were expected to avoid social events.
 - B) They rarely had time to make new friends.
 - C) They often lived far from their original families.**
 - D) They mainly relied on their husbands' relatives.
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Question 23. What is one key difference between best friends and regular friends?

- A) Best friends always agree on everything.
 - B) Best friends show deeper trust and openness.**
 - C) Best friends know what you really need.
 - D) Best friends rarely have conflicts or distance.
-

Question 24. According to the passage, why do people tend to invest more in a few close friends?

- A) Because it is considered rude to have many friends.
 - B) Because friendships formed later in life are less stable.
 - C) Because society expects people to maintain lifelong friendships.
 - D) Because people have limited time and emotional energy.**
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Question 25. According to Krebs, why do people often hide their friendship rankings?

- A) To spend more time building new friendships
- B) To avoid debates about spouses as best friends
- C) To make people believe they are the best friend**
- D) To increase their total number of social connections

答案 : D, C, B, D, C